

Talent ID and Recruitment

Assignment 2 (Weighting: 50%)

Due Date: Thursday, 12th December 2024, 14:00

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Workflow

1. Export Wyscout data to Excel
 - Minimum 10 league matches played 2024/25 (League One & Championship players)
 - Minimum 8 league matches played 2024/25 (Premier League players)
 - Data as of 27th November 2024
2. Import data to Jupyter Notebook and manipulate using Python
3. Identify high-performing players in League One (analysing percentile data)
4. Build a player profile with contextual information, performance data and a FA Four Corner Model scout report
5. Compare high-performing League One players to Championship and Premier League averages

EFL League One Talent ID

In this report I will identify and recommend three League One players.

Assessing their potential to play in the Championship and Premier League.



Player 1:

Kwame Poku



Player info

Nationality	Ghanian 
Age	23 (Aug 11, 2001)
Position	RW
Foot	Left
Height	5'10½"
Weight	67kg

2024/25 season (league)

Club	Peterborough 
App	16
Goals	10
xG	5.5
Assists	4
xA	3.1

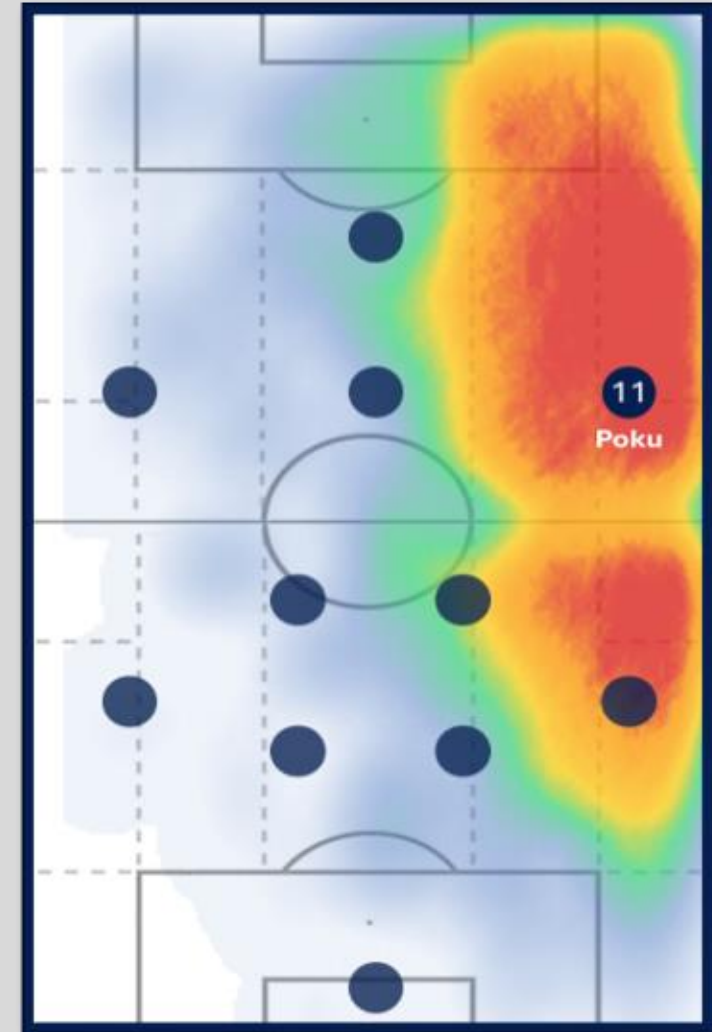
Role Breakdown: Kwame Poku

Peterborough United Game Model Features 2024/25

- ❑ Formation: 1-4-2-3-1
- ❑ Play out from the back often
- ❑ Rigid team shape in build-up, simple combinations
- ❑ Retain possession with short passes and few touches
- ❑ Press high up the pitch with midfield players stepping up frequently
- ❑ Attacking players stretch the pitch

Kwame Poku Responsibilities

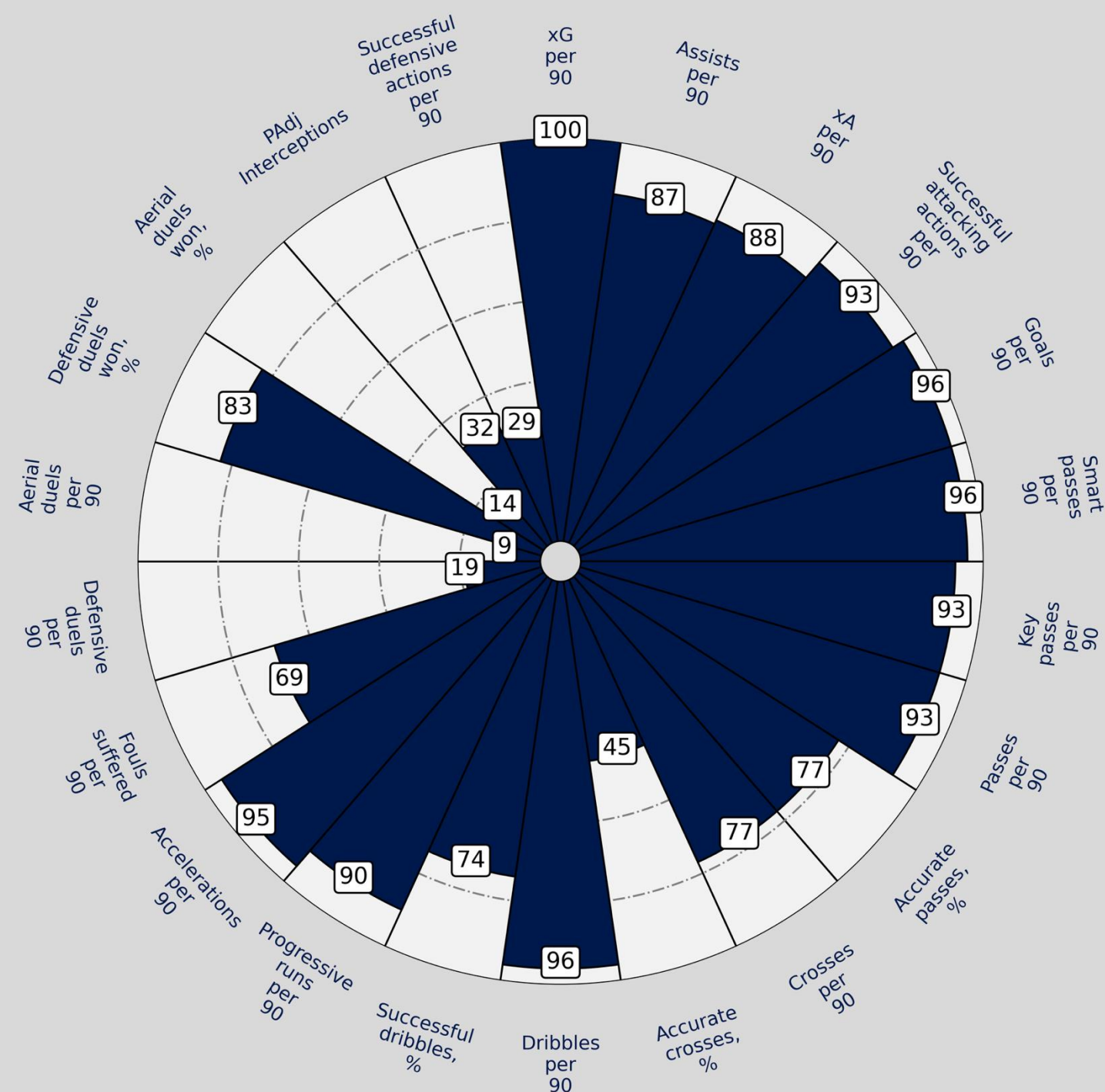
- ❑ Stretch the pitch offering width in possession
- ❑ Offer an option in build-up by coming inside if there is space
- ❑ Press opposition wide-CB or FB in a high-press
- ❑ Drop to RM in a mid-block
- ❑ Create goalscoring opportunities with crosses and passes



Kwame Poku Performance Data

Percentile Data based on:

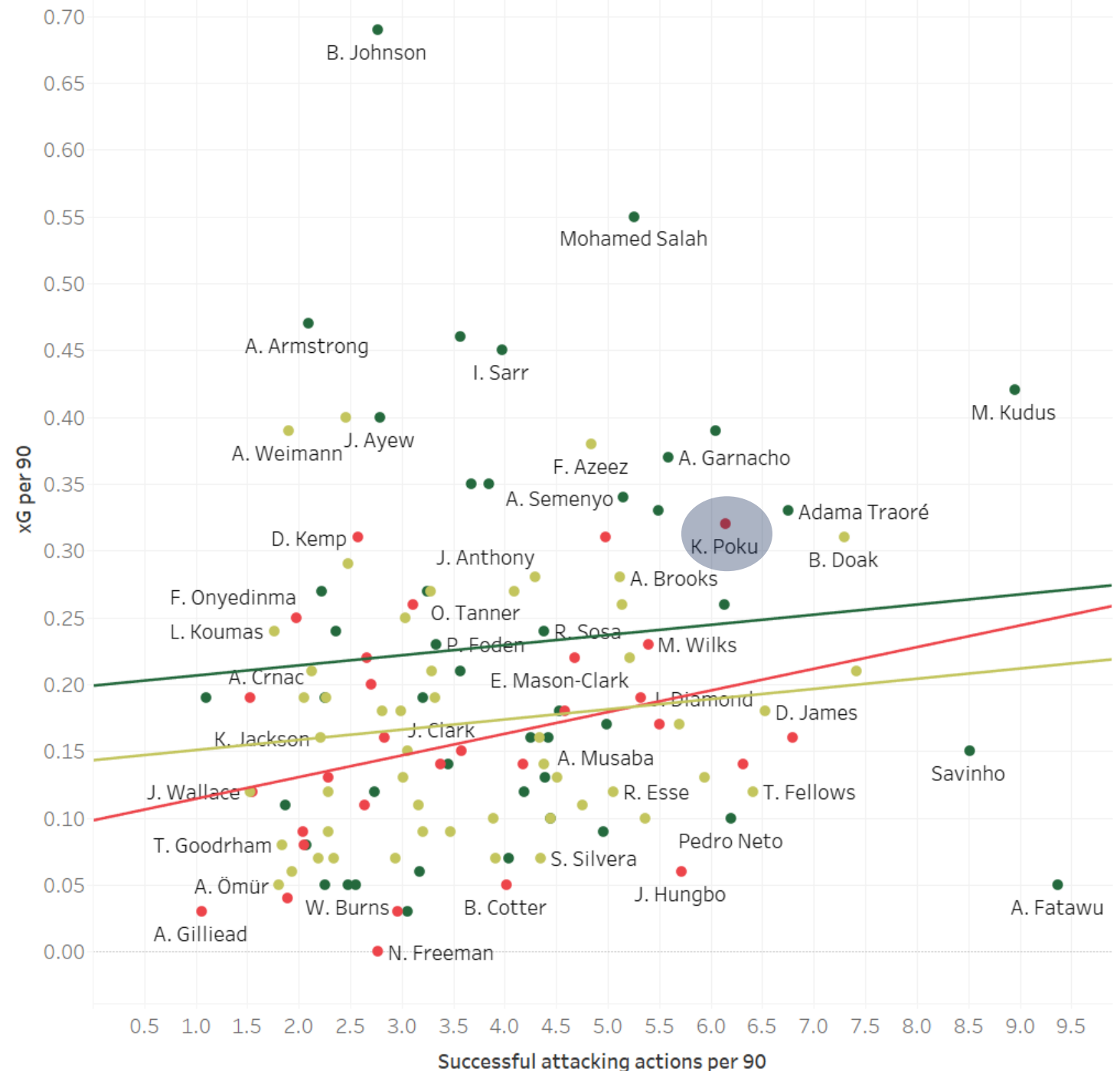
- 31 League One RW players
- Minimum of 10 League One matches played in 2024/25
- Data as of 27th November 2024



Comparison Data

Data based on:

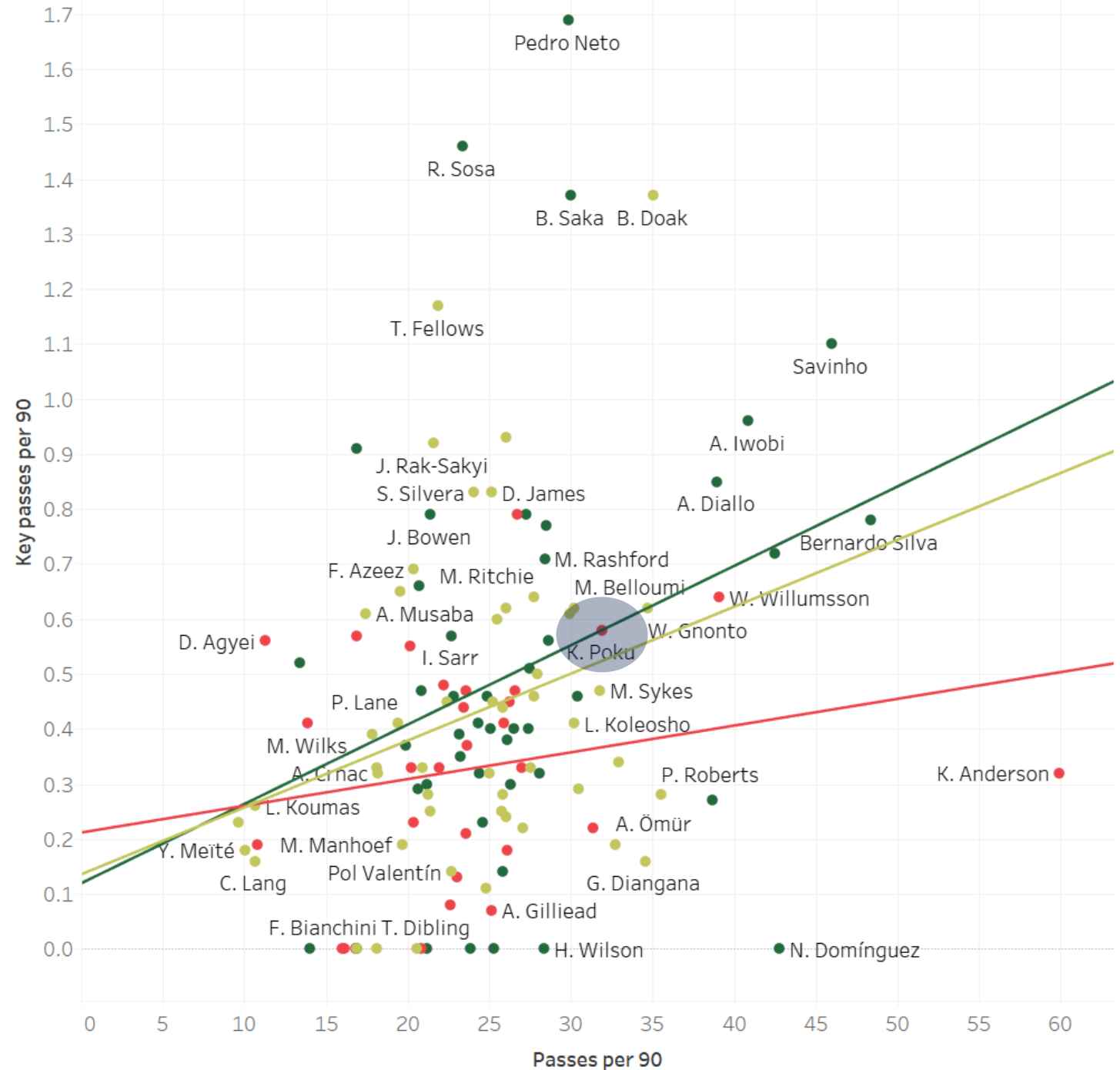
- 127 League One, Championship and Premier League RW players
- Minimum 10 league matches played 2024/25 (League One & Championship players)
- Minimum 8 league matches played 2024/25 (Premier League players)
- Data as of 27th November 2024



Comparison Data

Data based on:

- 127 League One, Championship and Premier League RW players
- Minimum 10 league matches played 2024/25 (League One & Championship players)
- Minimum 8 league matches played 2024/25 (Premier League players)
- Data as of 27th November 2024



What level could Poku play at?

Based on the performance data, scout report, and the Championship and Premier League data, I think Poku has the potential to play in the **Championship**.

- ❖ Poku has outstanding attacking data relative to League One RW's, ranking in the 90th percentile for Goals, Progressive Runs and Key Passes. This highlights Poku's ability to create and convert chances, he also has the highest Expected Goals in the league, suggesting that he has strong movement and anticipation in the final 3rd.
- ❖ In the scout report, I identified a number of skills which contribute to Poku's high-level performances. For example, Poku often drops his shoulder on his first touch to create separation from a defender and give him time on the ball. His style of play is similar to that of Saka or Doku, in that he likes to stand up a defender and react to their movements. Poku also displayed excellent psychological and social attributes, conveying a strong temperament with a hard-working and unselfish personality.
- ❖ Poku's attacking and passing data is above average compared to Championship and Premier League RW's, suggesting that his performances would be considered excellent in higher leagues.

Given that Poku is 23 and is excelling in League One, I believe that he has the potential to play in the Championship. I think that his technical ability and his physical attributes would allow him to perform in a possession-based team in the Championship. To improve further, Poku needs to display more tenacity in his defensive engagements and positioning.

Player 2:

Krystian Bielik



Player info

Nationality	Polish 
Age	26 (Jan 4, 1998)
Position	CB
Foot	Right
Height	6'3½"
Weight	78kg

2024/25 season (league)

Club	Birmingham 
App	11
Pts per game	2.1
GC per game	1.3
Games missed to suspension	1

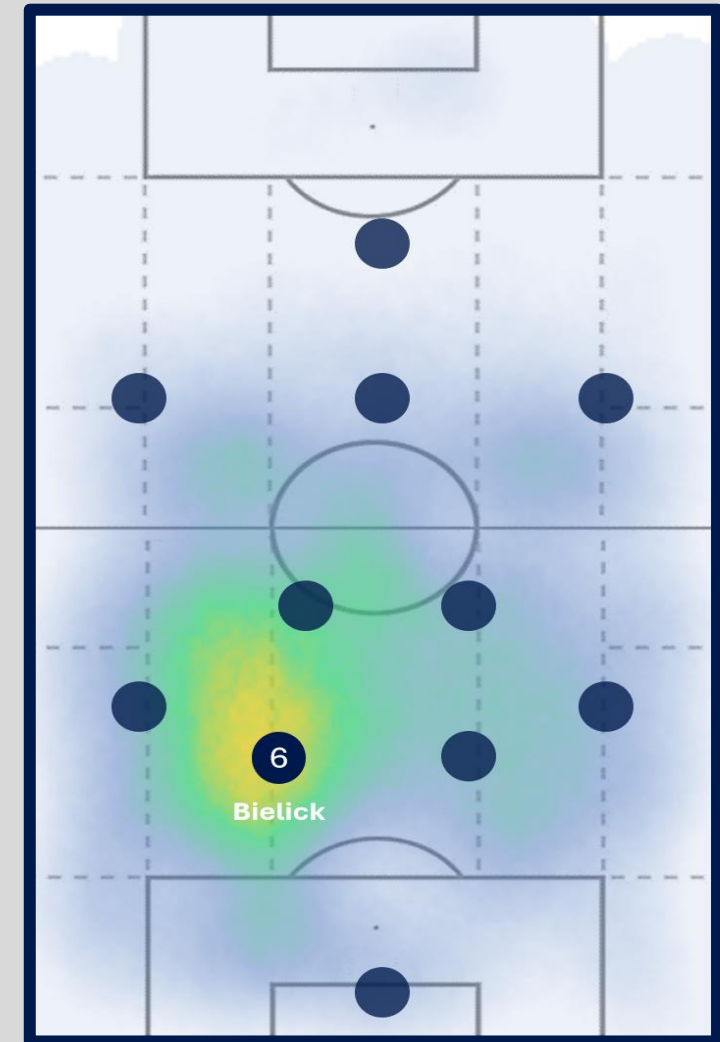
Role Breakdown: Krystian Bielik

Birmingham City Game Model Features 2024/25

- ❑ Formation: 1-4-2-3-1
- ❑ Heavily possession-based
- ❑ Steady build-up play tempo
- ❑ Tend to build-up in a 3+2 or 2+4 shape
- ❑ Lots of 3rd man runs in the 1st phase to unlock the spare man
- ❑ Wingers look to cross into the area often

Krystian Bielik Responsibilities

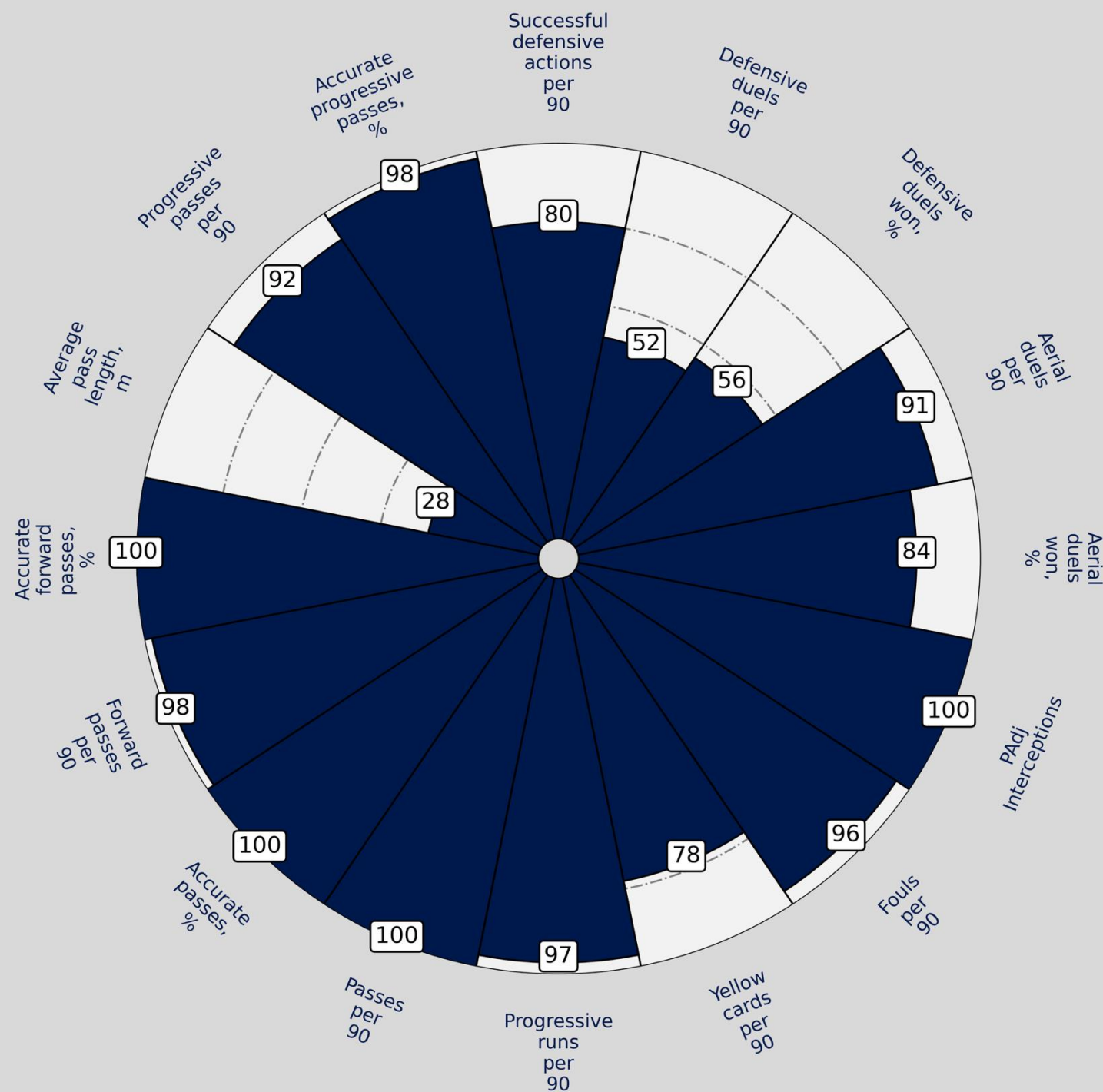
- ❑ Team captain – lead teammates with performance and professionalism
- ❑ Dictate tempo in build-up
- ❑ Nullify opposition counter attacks and retain possession
- ❑ Engage in a high number of defensive duels
- ❑ Retain possession as much as possible – dropping off and moving into space to receive passes in the defensive third



Krystian Bielik Performance Data

Percentile Data based on:

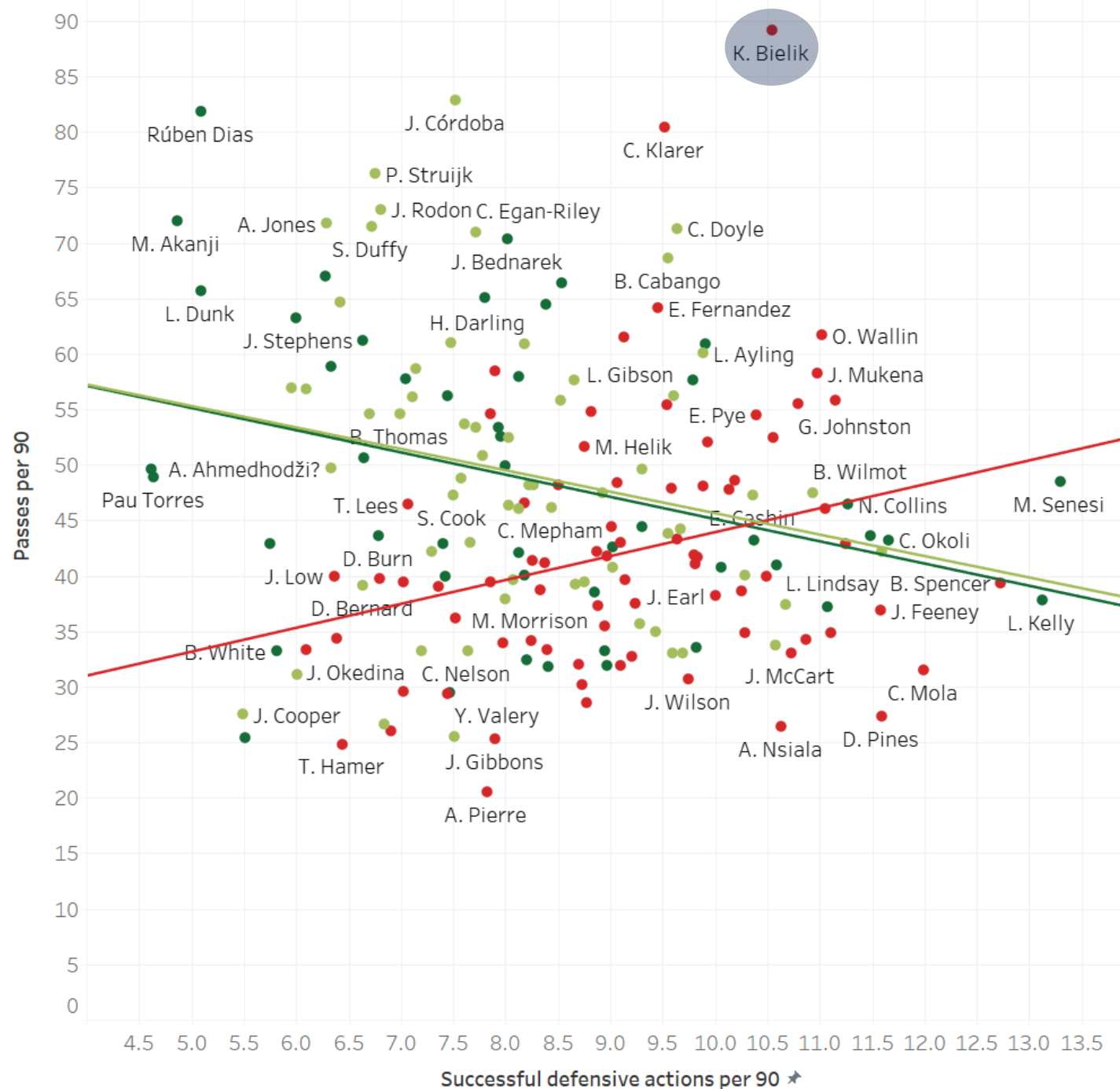
- 78 League One CB players
- Minimum of 10 League One matches played in 2024/25
- Data as of 27th November 2024



Comparison Data

Data based on:

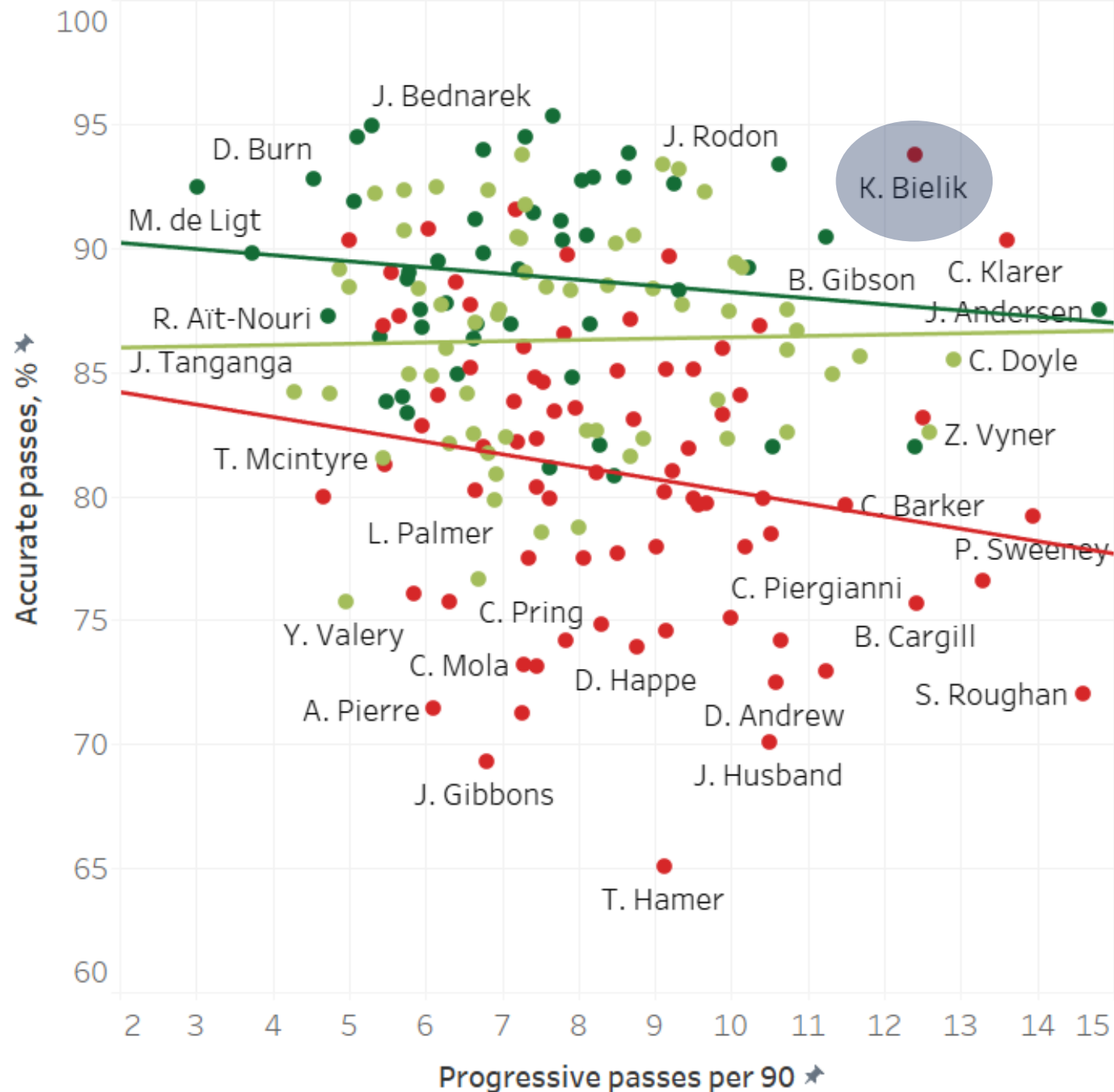
- 187 League One, Championship and Premier League CB players
- Minimum 10 league matches played 2024/25 (League One & Championship players)
- Minimum 8 league matches played 2024/25 (Premier League players)
- Data as of 27th November 2024



Comparison Data

Data based on:

- 187 League One, Championship and Premier League CB players
- Minimum 10 league matches played 2024/25 (League One & Championship players)
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- Data as of 27th November 2024



What level could Bielik play at?

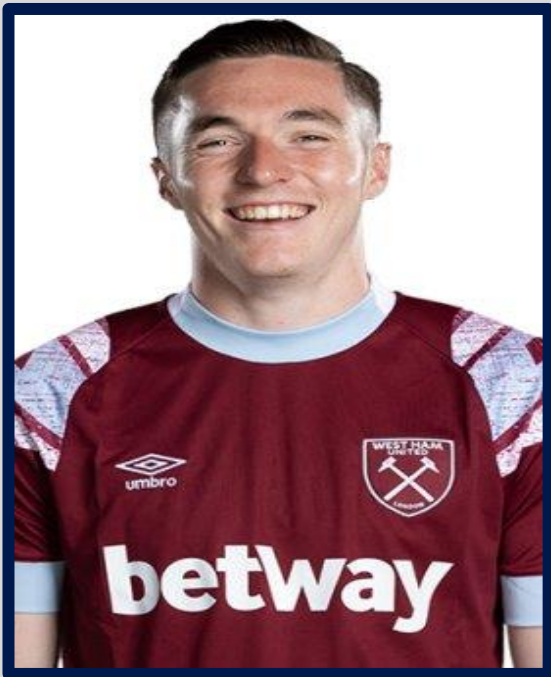
Based on the performance data, scout report, and the Championship and Premier League data, I think Bielik has the potential to play in the **Championship**.

- ❖ Bielik has excellent passing data relative to League One CB's, ranking highest in Pass Volume, Forward Pass Accuracy, and Padj Interceptions. While he is competent in the build-up phase, he also offers strong defensive ability, as he is in the 80th percentile for successful defensive actions.
- ❖ In the scout report, I found that Bielik excels as a middle CB in a back 3, as this allows him to control build-up play with passes into midfield and his ability to consistently find the spare man. However, the report did show that Bielik struggled with aerial duels. At times he arrived too early and too slowly which can cause him to be blocked by attackers. Also, although he possesses leadership qualities, he can lose control of his emotions evident in his sending off v Wrexham.
- ❖ Compared to Championship and Premier League CB's, Bielik is above average in terms of passing and defensive performance, suggesting that he has the potential to play at a higher level.

Based on my research, I believe that Bielik has the potential to play in the Championship. I think that his quality in the build-up phase would transfer into a possession-based team in the Championship. However, to compensate for his physical and defensive ability, he would be best suited as a middle CB in a back 3 system. Bielik also needs to improve his temperament to prevent further suspensions.

Player 3:

Conor Coventry



Player info

Nationality	Irish 
Age	24 (Mar 25, 2000)
Position	DM/CM
Foot	Right
Height	5'9½"
Weight	65kg

2024/25 season (league)

Club	Charlton 
App	16
G&A	2
Av passes per game	43
Pass Accuracy	84%
Duels Won	54%

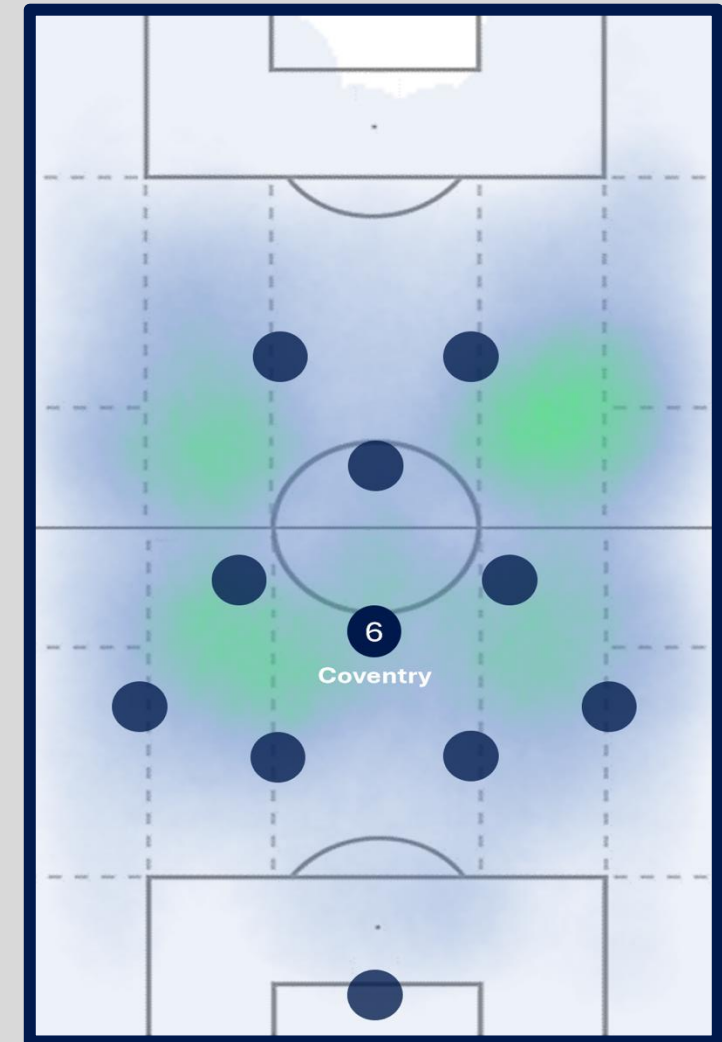
Role Breakdown: Conor Coventry

Charlton Athletics' Game Model Features 2024/25

- ❑ Formation: 1-4-3-1-2
- ❑ More direct style looking to play into the striker or the channels
- ❑ Look to compress the middle of the pitch with minimal width
- ❑ Defenders look to clear the ball rather than retain possession
- ❑ Long throws forward or into the area
- ❑ Look to deliver the ball early into the area

Conor Coventry Responsibilities

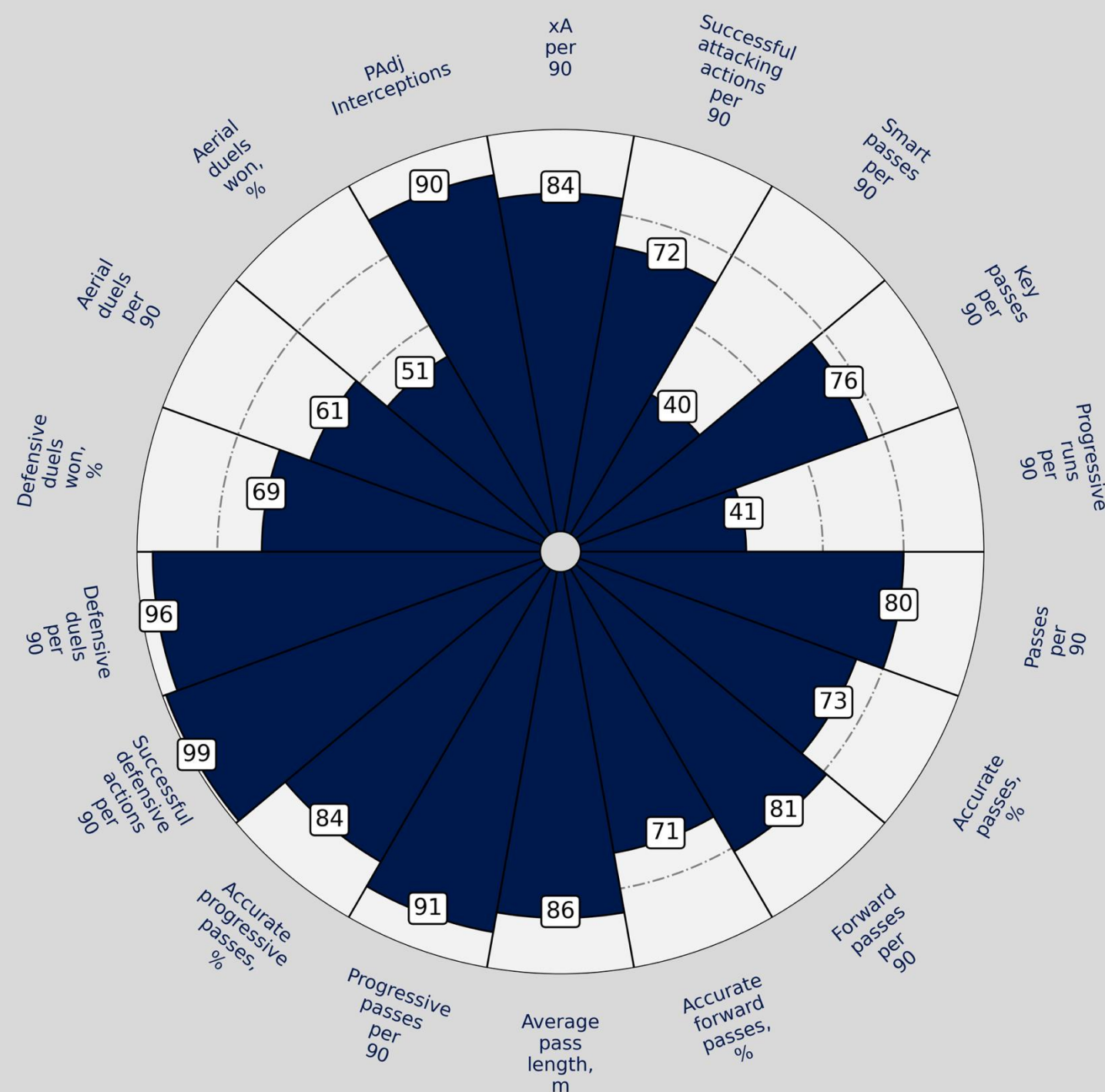
- ❑ Engage in a high number of defensive duels across the pitch
- ❑ Maintain attacks by sitting as an anchor and sweeping up loose balls
- ❑ Offer composure on the ball, playing simple passes allowing teammates to reset
- ❑ Look to create goal-scoring opportunities with diagonals, balls into the channel, or with crosses into the area



Conor Coventry Performance Data

Percentile Data based on:

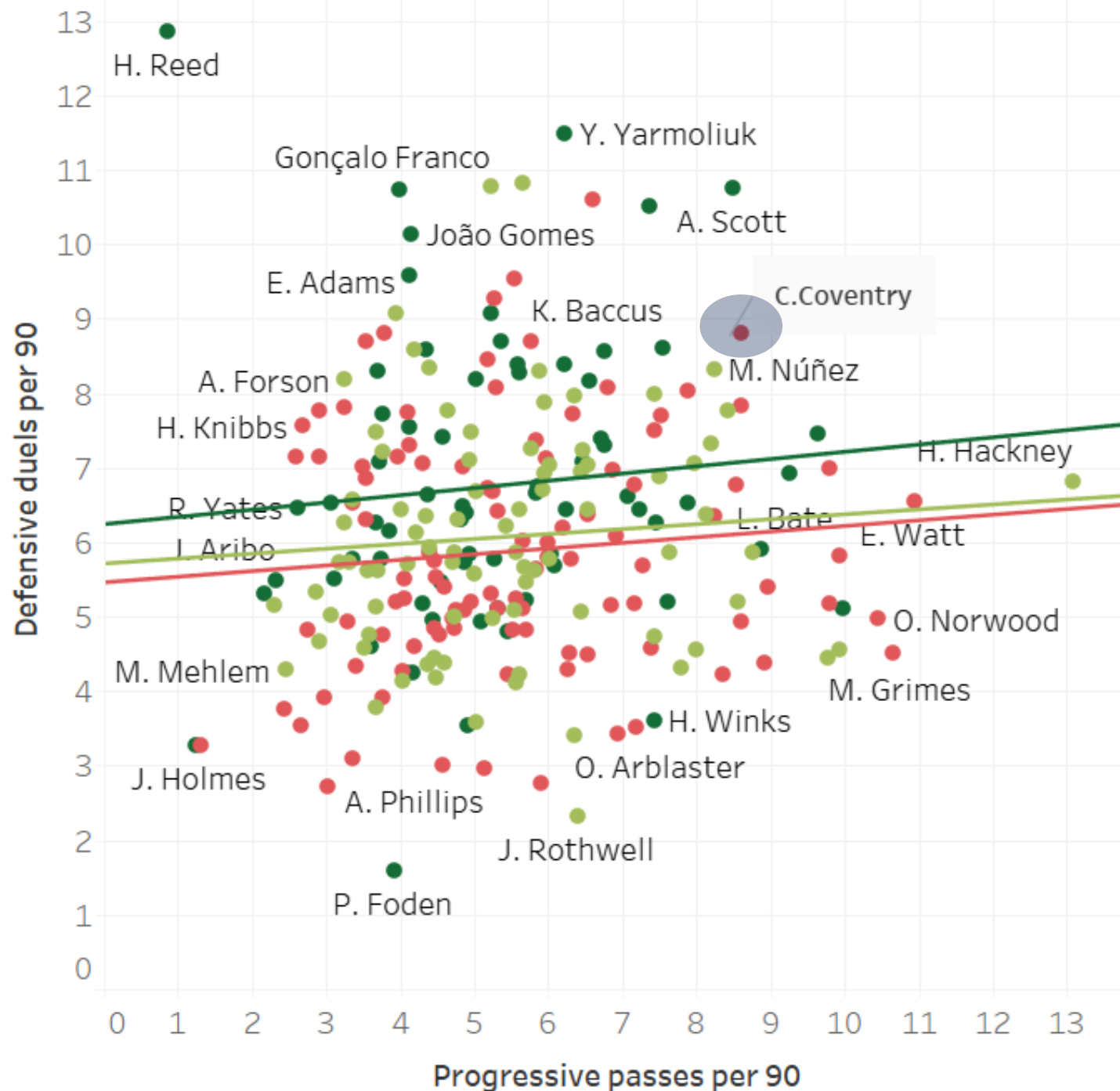
- 102 League One DM/CM players
- Minimum of 10 League One matches played in 2024/25
- Data as of 27th November 2024



Comparison Data

Data based on:

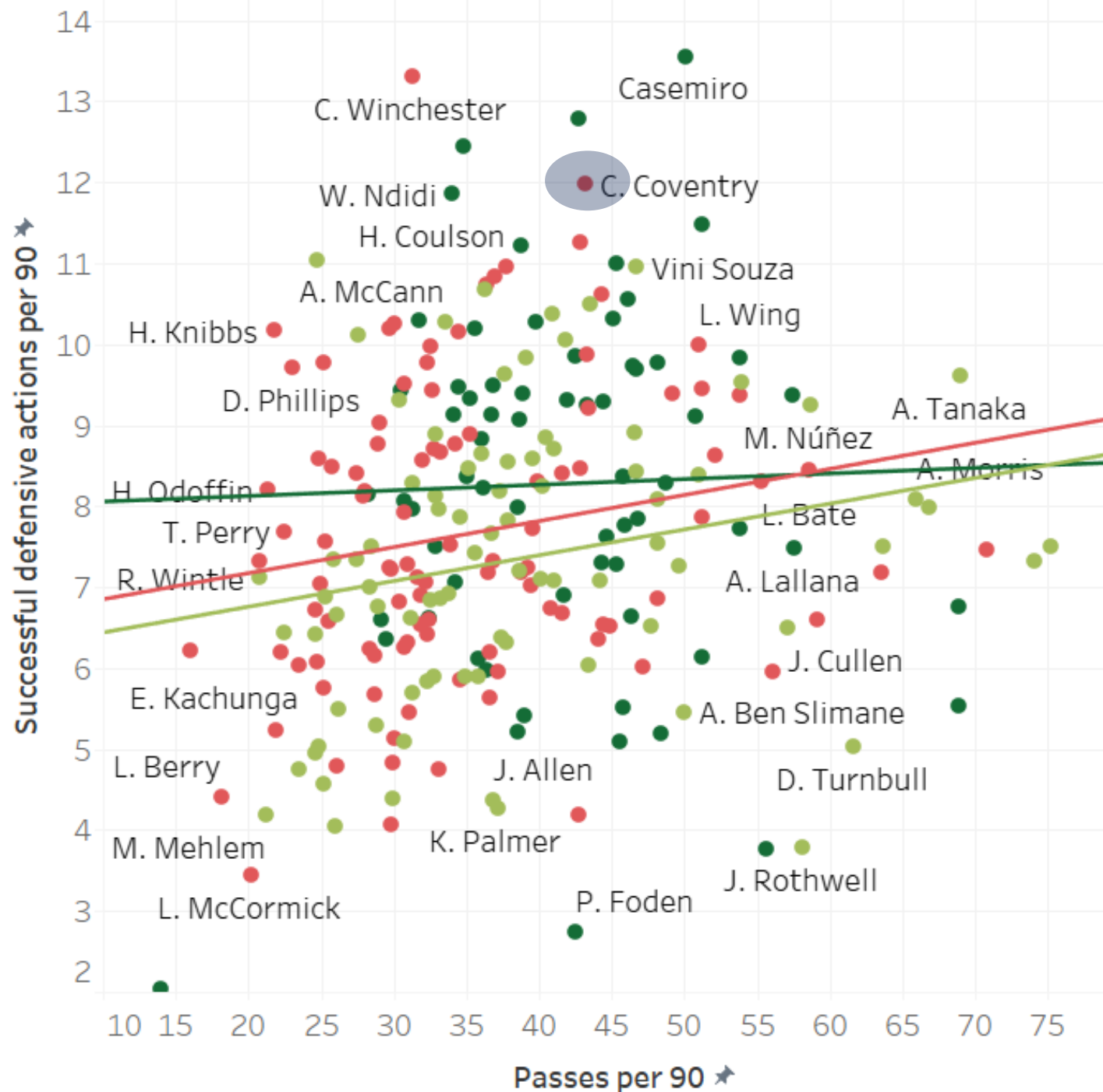
- 255 League One, Championship and Premier League DM/CM players
- Minimum 10 league matches played 2024/25 (League One & Championship players)
- Minimum 8 league matches played 2024/25 (Premier League players)
- Data as of 27th November 2024



Comparison Data

Data based on:

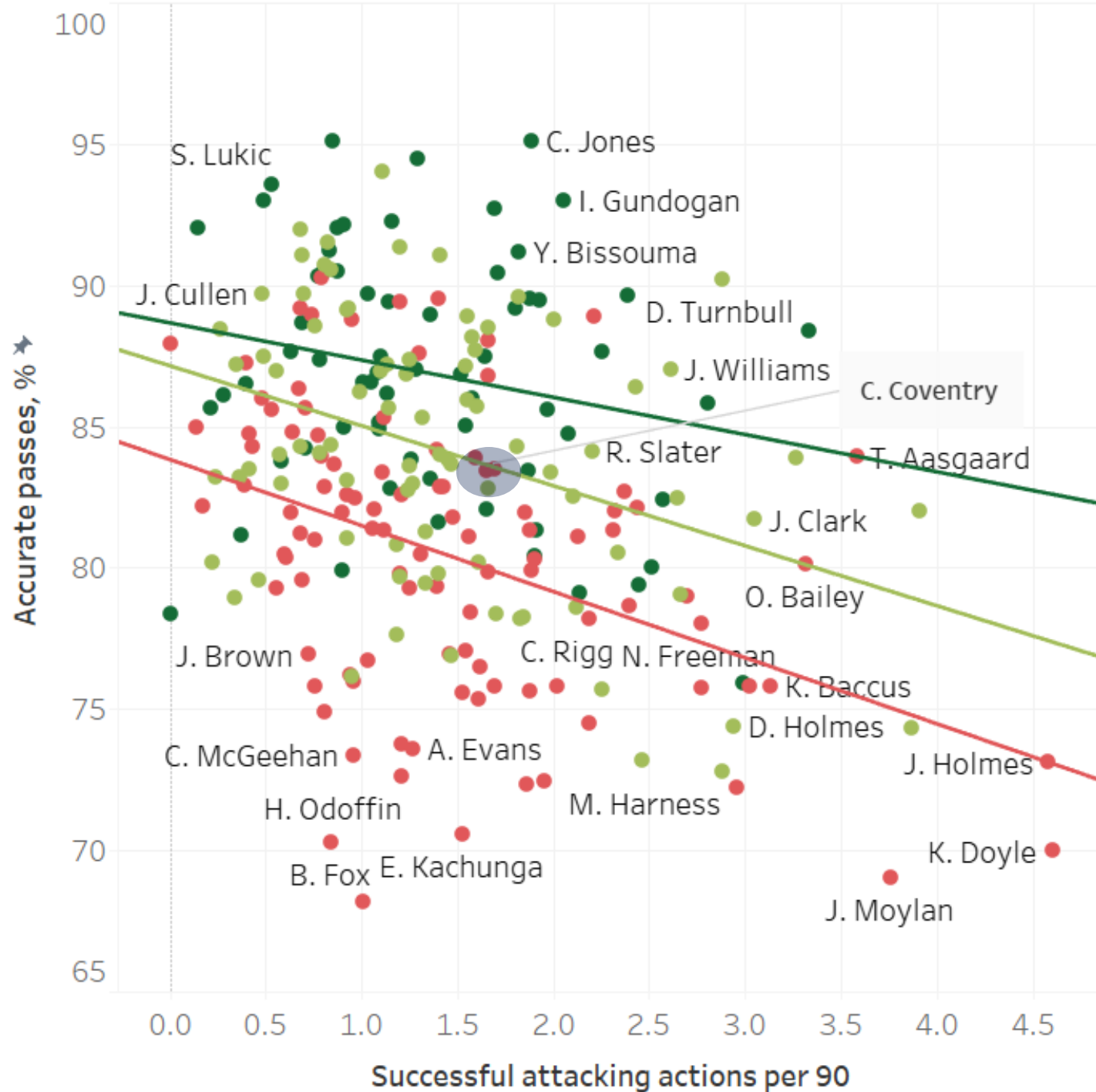
- 255 League One, Championship and Premier League DM/CM players
- Minimum 10 league matches played 2024/25 (League One & Championship players)
- Minimum 8 league matches played 2024/25 (Premier League players)
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Comparison Data

Data based on:

- 255 League One, Championship and Premier League DM/CM players
- Minimum 10 league matches played 2024/25 (League One & Championship players)
- Minimum 8 league matches played 2024/25 (Premier League players)
- Data as of 27th November 2024



What level could Coventry play at?

Based on the performance data, scout report, and the Championship and Premier League data, I think Coventry has the potential to play in the **Championship**.

- ❖ Coventry has outstanding passing and defensive data relative to League One DM/CM's, ranking highly in Successful Defensive Actions, Progressive Passes, and Expected Assists. Coventry offers a strong balance of being effective in attacking, defending, and the build-up phase.
- ❖ In the scout report, I found that Coventry is utilised as the deepest midfielder in a midfield diamond. Coventry possesses a strong passing range; always playing short passes to the correct foot of the receiver and striking accurate long balls and crosses with pace. In addition, he has a good sense of defensive positioning, understanding when to engage an attacker and when to defend the space. He also possesses leadership qualities, instructing teammates and performing a range of responsibilities for the team.
- ❖ Compared to Championship and Premier League DM/CM's, Coventry is above average in terms of passing and defensive performance, suggesting that he has the potential to play at a higher level.

Based on my research, I believe that Coventry has the potential to play in the Championship. I think that his strong game sense and all-round ability would allow him to excel in a double-pivot role in the Championship. He is capable of effectively contributing to possession-based build-up play or playing in a direct system with more defensive responsibilities.